

Weekend Batch Cooking Blueprint

The 2-Hour Sunday Prep Plan to Run Your Kitchen on Auto-Pilot All Week

Introduction: The Meal Prep Secret

The biggest reason parents resort to store-bought biscuits, packaged foods, and instant noodles during the week is decision fatigue and lack of time. By dedicating **2 hours on Sunday afternoon**, you can prepare all the foundational sauces, doughs, and veggie purees, cutting down weekday cooking time to under 10 minutes per meal.

Section 1: The 2-Hour Sunday Workflow

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title Sunday Prep Timeline (120 Minutes)

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section Step-by-Step

Boil & Roast (Eggs, Beans, Makhanas) :active, 0, 30

Veggie Chopping & Pureeing :30, 60

Dough Kneading & Sauce Simmering :60, 90

Portioning & Labeling :90, 120

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Phase 1: Boil & Roast (Minutes 0–30)

Boil Chickpeas & Kidney Beans: Boil 2 cups of chickpeas and kidney beans. Once cooled, store in airtight containers. (Use for quick salads, hummus, or curries).

Boil Eggs: Boil 6 eggs. Keep them in their shells and refrigerate.

Roast Makhanas: Dry roast a large batch of makhanas in ghee and store in a glass jar.

Phase 2: Chopping & Pureeing (Minutes 30–60)

The Veggie Puree Base (Stealth Veggie Hack): Boil bottle gourd (lauki), carrots, and tomatoes together. Blend into a smooth orange puree. Portion into three glass jars.

Jar A:* Use for pasta sauce on Tuesday.

Jar B:* Use to knead roti dough on Wednesday.

Jar C:* Add to dal tadka on Thursday.

Chop Raw Veggies: Mince carrots, capsicum, and cabbage. Store in containers lined with paper towels (absorbs moisture and keeps veggies crisp for 5 days).

Phase 3: Kneading & Sauces (Minutes 60–90)

Stealth Doughs: Knead whole wheat flour mixed with sattu powder or spinach puree. Wrap tightly in cling wrap and refrigerate.

Prepare Hummus / Spreads: Blend boiled chickpeas, sesame seeds, garlic, olive oil, and lemon juice into hummus. Store in a glass jar.

Phase 4: Portioning & Storage (Minutes 90–120)

Store in Glass: Use glass containers instead of plastic to keep purees fresh and prevent chemical leaching.

Label Everything: Write the prep date on masking tape and stick it to the jars.

Section 2: Storage & Freezing Guidelines

Use this chart to ensure safety and freshness:

Prep Item	Fridge Life (4°C)	Freezer Life (-18°C)	Best Reheating Method
Stealth Veggie Puree	3 Days	1 Month	Simmer in a hot pan for 2 minutes
Kneaded Dough	2 Days	Do Not Freeze	Let sit at room temp for 15 mins, then roll
Boiled Chickpeas	4 Days	2 Months	Steam or rinse in warm water
Boiled Eggs (in shell)	5 Days	Do Not Freeze	Peel and slice immediately
Hummus / Spreads	5 Days	Do Not Freeze	Serve cold or at room temperature
Homemade Nut Butter	1 Month	3 Months	Stir well (oil separation is natural)
Baked Oat Cookies	7 Days	2 Months	Warm in oven for 60 seconds